CEO

Walter Ng, Spread Maximizer

CEO · EXECUTIVE

HIRE
◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Longevity or Low Interest Rates clauses.

At the start of your turn, look at the top card of your deck. You may put it on the bottom.

Can quote the spread between the portfolio yield and the crediting rate to four decimals, at dinner.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 196 / 366

OFFICE LOCATION

Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN
◆ 4 *branch only*

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

The flag is a big plus!

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 344 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN
● 1 *turn start*

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Volatility ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 007 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN
● 1 *turn start*

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Volatility ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 007 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN
● 1 *turn start*

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Volatility ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

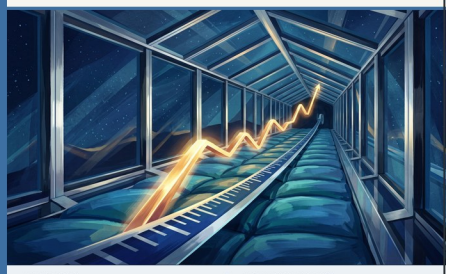
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 007 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

CARRYING COST
● 1 *each turn*

▲ Short-Term Equity ▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

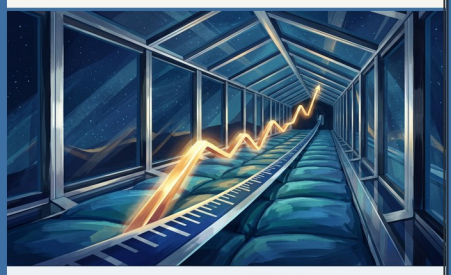
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 008 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

CARRYING COST
● 1 *each turn*

▲ Short-Term Equity ▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

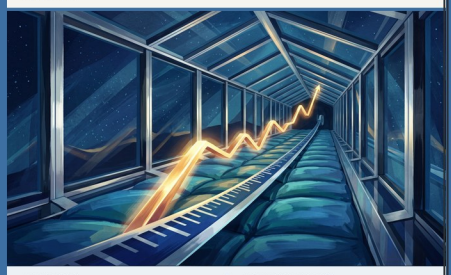
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 008 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

CARRYING COST
● 1 *each turn*

▲ Short-Term Equity ▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 008 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY
◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN
● 1 *turn start*

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 009 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 1 *turn start*

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 009 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 1 *turn start*

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 009 / 366

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 0 *turn start*

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 010 / 366

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 0 *turn start*

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 010 / 366

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 0 *turn start*

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 010 / 366

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 0 *turn start*

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 010 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Longevity Income Rider

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 1 *turn start*

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Regulation ▼ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A promise to keep paying, even when customers insist on living forever.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 011 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Longevity Income Rider

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 1 *turn start*

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Regulation ▼ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A promise to keep paying, even when customers insist on living forever.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 011 / 366

FUNDING SOURCE

Buffered Index Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn*

MARGIN ● 1 *turn start*

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Volatility ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers get upside, you get basis risk, and everyone gets a brochure.

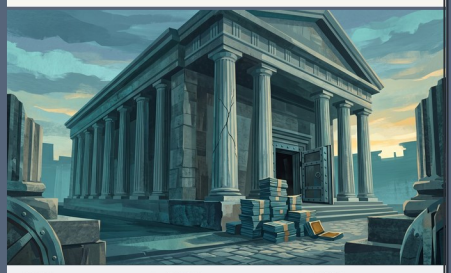
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 012 / 366

INVESTMENT

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST ◆2 | YIELD ●1 each turn | SALE 1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 051 / 366

INVESTMENT

Mortgage-Backed Securities

INVESTMENT

COST ◆3 | YIELD ●2 each turn | SALE 2 any time

▲ Property Value ▼ Low Interest Rates

Destroyed if Great Recession or U.S. Housing Crash hits you.

No longer the most volatile MBS.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 056 / 366

INVESTMENT

Mortgage-Backed Securities

INVESTMENT

COST ◆3 | YIELD ●2 each turn | SALE 2 any time

▲ Property Value ▼ Low Interest Rates

Destroyed if Great Recession or U.S. Housing Crash hits you.

No longer the most volatile MBS.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 056 / 366

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Dynamic Hedging Program

TREATY

COST ◆3 | CARRYING COST ●1 each turn

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.

Halve your loss from Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses (round down).

The hedge works perfectly, except when the market moves.

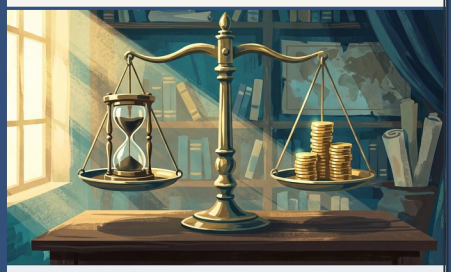
A F

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 113 / 366

RISK MANAGEMENT

Longevity Swap

TREATY



COST ◆2

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Halve your loss from Longevity clauses (round down).

Your retirees can live as long as they like, now that someone else is paying for the extra years.

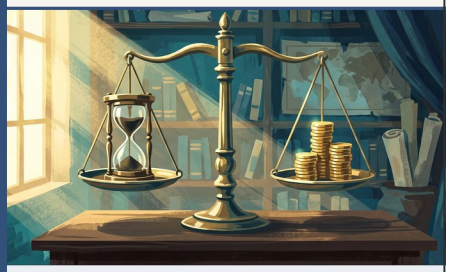
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 112 / 366

RISK MANAGEMENT

Longevity Swap

TREATY



COST ◆2

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Halve your loss from Longevity clauses (round down).

Your retirees can live as long as they like, now that someone else is paying for the extra years.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 112 / 366

RISK MANAGEMENT

Protective Put

COVER

COST ◆2

COVER

Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

A floor under one position, paid for up front.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 130 / 366

RISK MANAGEMENT

Protective Put

COVER

COST ◆2

COVER

Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

A floor under one position, paid for up front.

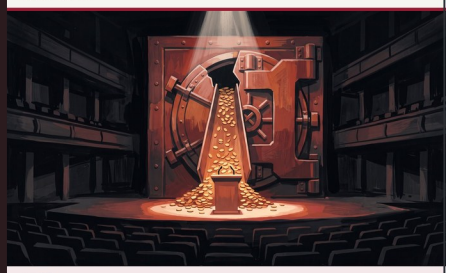
ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 130 / 366

RISK MANAGEMENT

Reserve Release

DARK

RESPONSE



COST ◆1

DARK RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Gain 3 Surplus.

This quarter's earnings agree that last year's reserves were too cautious.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 138 / 366

TALENT

ALM Director

RISK & COMPLIANCE

HIRE

◆ 4

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Halve your loss from Low Interest Rates clauses (round down).

Matches every liability to an asset and every asset to a spreadsheet tab.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 174 / 366

TALENT

Hedge Desk Trader

RISK & COMPLIANCE

HIRE

◆ 3

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, or Volatility clauses.

Rebalances the hedge at 3 a.m. so the guarantee still works at 9.

A F

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 175 / 366

TALENT

Chief Investment Officer

EXECUTIVE

HIRE

◆ 4

Requires an Annuity funding source.

At the start of your turn, if you control an investment, gain 1 more Surplus.

Believes every problem can be solved with another two basis points of yield.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 177 / 366

RISK MANAGEMENT

Cook the Books

DARK

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 1

DARK RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

The numbers were fine once they had a little help getting there.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 137 / 366

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Nuclear Verdict

LITIGATION

COST ◆ 4 | HITS Target opponent

▲ Litigation

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Litigation exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 2 more.

The jury took forty minutes to reach a verdict that will take four years to appeal.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 266 / 366

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY

COST ◆ 4 | HITS Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 271 / 366

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Whistleblower

CORPORATE

COST ◆ 3 | HITS Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 293 / 366

SIGNATURE FUNDING SOURCE

Funding Agreement Notes

ANNUITY · FINANCIALS

CAPACITY ◆ 1 *Leverage a turn* | MARGIN ● 0 *turn start*

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Liquidity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Sold like a bond, rated like a policy, spent like a lending fund.

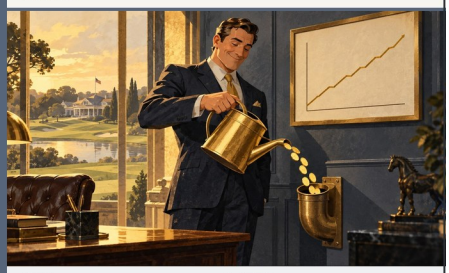
A F

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 043 / 366

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Feeder Fund

ILLIQUID



COST ◆ 3 | YIELD ● 2 *each turn*

SIGNATURE ILLIQUID

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Whistleblower, Congressional Hearing, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Madoff Unmasked hits you.

Up about one percent a month for years, in every market, and nobody wanted to be rude and ask how.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 081 / 366

OFFICE LOCATION

Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN
◆ 3 *branch only*

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

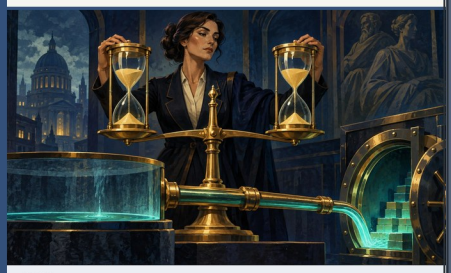
Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 347 / 366

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

LDI Overlay

TREATY



COST
◆ 0

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Low Interest Rates exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

Matched for thirty years, with the cash due by four o'clock.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 156 / 366

INVESTMENT

Long Straddle

INVESTMENT

COST ◆ 3 | SALE 1 *any time* | CARRYING COST ● 1 *each turn*

▼ Short-Term Equity

When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recoveries. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

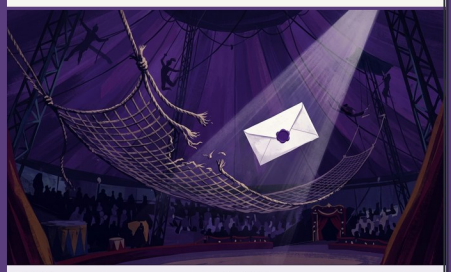
Pays whichever way the market breaks, as long as it breaks before the premium runs out.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 096 / 366

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Reinsurer Insolvency

MARKET



COST ◆ 1 | HITS Target opponent

Target opponent has one Risk Management card to discard, chosen by the runner.

The treaty was airtight. The reinsurer was not.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 330 / 366

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Noncompete Injunction

LITIGATION

COST ◆ 2 | HITS Target opponent

Target opponent has one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

The judge agreed that the agreement was enforceable, and that the new job started in eighteen months.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 332 / 366

TOOL

Early Warning System

DATA

PRICE
◆ 2

▲ Cyber

Commit this tool to look at the top card of the Stress Test pile. Only you see it.

Forty dashboards, one blinking light, and an intern assigned to watch it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 366 / 366

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

1918 Influenza

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1918

HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE | ACT OF GOD
▲ Mortality | ▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

The 1918 influenza pandemic swept the world in three waves and killed tens of millions of people, many of them young adults.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 236 / 366

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003

HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE | ACT OF GOD
▲ Mortality | ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 229 / 366

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Hurricane Andrew

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1992

HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE | ACT OF GOD
▲ Nat Cat: Flood | ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

In August 1992, Hurricane Andrew came ashore south of Miami with winds above 160 mph and destroyed or damaged more than 100,000 homes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA — NO. 232 / 366

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

IFRS 17

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2023

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

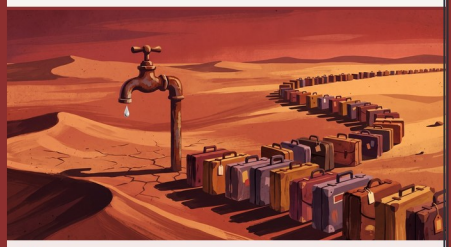
Every company loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on its board. Then each company discards its hand and draws that many cards.

On January 1, 2023, IFRS 17, the first full international accounting standard for insurance contracts, took effect. Effective for fiscal years beginning after the one you planned for.

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Dash for Cash

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In March 2020, investors sold almost everything, even U.S. Treasuries, to raise cash, until the Federal Reserve stepped in.

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Public health agencies have tracked the strain for years.

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD DEVELOPING EVENT

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: stage 1 now, the next stage at the end of each later round.

Stage 1. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Vietnam War

GEOPOLITICAL · AS-IF REPLAY, 1965

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Mortality

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Inflation exposure and 4 per Mortality exposure.

In 1965 the United States sent combat troops to Vietnam, starting a long war that cost millions of lives and helped push up inflation at home.